Thoughts on Nock: Nockchain pays miners to produce zero-knowledge proofs

$7.5M

Reported funding, including a $5M seed round led by Delphi Ventures

Developer	Zorp
Token	NOCK, newly issued to miners
Consensus	Proof-of-work in which miners generate zero-knowledge proofs
Other investors	North Island Ventures, CMCC Global and others
DCG	No direct investment verified

How it works

Bitcoin miners compete on hash puzzles with no use outside the network. Nockchain miners instead compete to produce zero-knowledge proofs, so the work that secures the chain is the kind of computation applications could pay for. A proof lets a party verify a computation without seeing its inputs, which extends privacy into financial services and confidential computing.

Investment thesis

Investor commentary places NOCK alongside alternative stores of value, new proof-of-work coins and privacy coins, combining Bitcoin's monetary properties with programmable public and private applications.

What has to be true

Demand emerges for the proofs miners produce, beyond the work needed to secure the chain.

Proof generation on Nockchain is cost-competitive with dedicated proving services.

Enterprise users accept a proof-of-work network for confidential computation.

Open questions

The same commentary linked NOCK's October 2025 price rise to the Zcash rally, so recent performance may reflect sentiment toward privacy coins more than usage. Funding details are as reported by the company and investors.

Sources: Zorp and Nockchain project materials; Delphi Digital, $NOCK (13 Oct 2025); investor commentary attributed to Zurlo in draft notes (attribution to be confirmed).